

Word family: **stay / stayed / staying**

Base word: stay

Past tense: stayed

Past participle: stayed

Related forms / useful extensions: staying, stay-at-home, staying power

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “That image really **stayed with me**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **stay with someone** is figurative.

It means that an image, idea, experience, remark, or memory **continues to remain strongly in someone’s mind after the original moment has passed**.

繁體中文: **某個畫面、想法或經歷在事情過去後仍長時間留在某人的記憶或思緒中，令人一直記得、印象深刻**

中文翻譯:

> “That image really stayed with me.”

「那個意象真的**一直留在我的腦海中，令我久久不能忘記**。」

stay with someone = 持續留在某人的記憶或思緒中，使人久久仍記得

1. **stay + place (地方) — 留在某處; 不離開**

This is one of the central meanings of **stay**.

Meaning: To remain in a particular place instead of leaving it.

Practice 1

> “Please **stay** here until I come back.”

「請**留在這裡，不要離開**，直到我回來。」

Practice 2

> “She decided to **stay** at the office a little longer.”

「她決定在辦公室**多留一會兒**。」

stay + place = 繼續留在某個地方，而不是離開或前往其他地方

2. **stay + adjective/state** (狀態／情況) — 保持某種狀態

Meaning: To continue to be in a particular condition or state.

Practice 3

> “Try to **stay calm**.”

「盡量**保持冷靜**。」

Practice 4

> “The café **stayed open** until midnight.”

「咖啡店一直**保持營業狀態**到午夜。」

stay + adjective = 某人或某事物持續處於某種狀態，沒有發生改變

Common patterns:

* **stay calm** = 保持冷靜

* **stay quiet** = 保持安靜

* **stay awake** = 保持清醒

* **stay healthy** = 保持健康

* **stay open** = 繼續營業／保持開放

3. **stay** = continue to be the same / remain unchanged (情況／數量／特質) — 維持不變；保持原狀

Meaning: To continue at the same level, position, condition, or value.

Practice 5

> “Prices have **stayed** relatively stable.”

「價格一直**維持相對穩定, 沒有太大變化**。」

Practice 6

> “The temperature **stayed** below zero all day.”

「氣溫整天都**維持在零度以下**。」

****stay = 某個數值、情況或特質持續維持原來狀態****

This is really the same broad semantic idea as #2 — ****remaining rather than changing**** — but numerical and situational contexts are useful to recognize separately.

4. ****stay with + person(記憶／意象／說話) — 長時間留在某人心中; 令人久久不能忘記****

This is your original meaning.

****Meaning:**** For something memorable to continue to occupy someone's thoughts or memory.

Practice 7 — Original

> “That image really **stayed with me**.”

「那個意象真的**一直留在我的腦海中, 令我久久不能忘記**。」

Practice 8

> “Something the teacher said **stayed with me** for years.”

「老師說過的一番話多年來一直**留在我的心中, 令我一直記得**。」

Practice 9

> “The final scene of the film **stayed with her** long after it ended.”

「電影結束很久後, 最後那一幕仍然**深深留在她的記憶中**。」

****stay with someone = 某個畫面、說話、感受或經歷在事情結束後仍持續存在於某人的記憶中****

5. **stay with + person/family (住宿對象) — 暫住在某人家中; 與某人同住一段時間**

Same form, completely different meaning from #4.

Meaning: To live temporarily in someone's home.

Practice 10

> "I'm **staying with** my sister this weekend."

「這個週末我會**暫住在姐姐／妹妹家中**。」

Practice 11

> "They **stayed with** friends while their apartment was being repaired."

「公寓維修期間, 他們**暫住在朋友家**。」

stay with someone = 暫時住在某人的住所, 而不是表示「記住某人」

Compare:

> "That memory **stayed with me**."

> = 那段記憶一直留在我心中。

> "My cousin **stayed with me**."

> = 我表親暫時住在我家。

Context completely changes the meaning.

6. **stay at/in + accommodation/place (酒店／地方) — 暫住; 住宿**

Meaning: To live somewhere temporarily, especially while travelling.

Practice 12

> "We **stayed at** a small hotel near the station."

「我們在車站附近一家小酒店**住宿**。」

Practice 13

> “She **stayed in** Paris for three weeks.”

「她在巴黎**逗留／暫住了三個星期**。」

stay at/in + place = 在某地方短期住宿或逗留, 而不是永久居住

7. **stay** = remain somewhere for a period as a guest/visitor (短期逗留) — 逗留; 停留

This does not necessarily imply sleeping there.

Practice 14

> “We **stayed** for another hour after dinner.”

「晚飯後, 我們又**逗留了一個小時**。」

Practice 15

> “I can’t **stay** long because I have another appointment.”

「我不能**逗留太久**, 因為之後還有另一個約會。」

stay = 在某地方繼續逗留一段時間, 而不是立即離開

8. **stay** = continue doing/being connected to something (持續參與／繼續維持) — 繼續; 堅持

Meaning: To continue participating in or maintaining a situation rather than withdrawing or stopping.

Practice 16

> “She decided to **stay** in the competition.”

「她決定**繼續參加比賽, 不退出**。」

Practice 17

> “He plans to **stay** in the profession for several more years.”

「他打算再在這個行業**繼續發展幾年**。」

****stay = 繼續處於某項活動、職業或情況之中，而不是退出或停止****

9. ****stay + direction/course (方向／路線) — 繼續沿著某方向／路線****

****Meaning:**** To continue following a particular route, position, or course.

Practice 18

> “****Stay**** on this road for another five kilometres.”

「沿著這條路****繼續走****五公里。」

Practice 19

> “Please ****stay**** in your lane.”

「請****保持在自己的行車線內****。」

****stay = 繼續保持在某條路線、位置或方向上，不偏離****

This still comes from the broader idea of ****remaining rather than moving away****.

10. ****stay = temporary visit/period of accommodation (短期住宿／逗留) — 逗留；住宿期間****

Here, ****stay**** is a noun.

Practice 20

> “We enjoyed our ****stay**** at the hotel.”

「我們很享受在酒店的****住宿期間****。」

Practice 21

> “Her ****stay**** in Japan lasted three months.”

「她在日本的****逗留期****持續了三個月。」

****a stay = 在某個地方暫時居住或逗留的一段時間****

Common expressions:

* **a short stay** = 短期逗留

* **an overnight stay** = 過夜住宿

* **a hospital stay** = 住院期間

* **hotel stay** = 酒店住宿

11. **hospital stay (住院) — 住院期間**

A very common extension of the noun meaning.

Practice 22

> “He needed a short **hospital stay** after the operation.”

「手術後，他需要**短期住院**。」

Practice 23

> “Her **hospital stay** lasted five days.”

「她的**住院期**持續了五天。」

hospital stay = 某人在醫院留院接受治療或觀察的一段時間

12. **stay = legal suspension/postponement (法律程序暫停) — 暫緩; 中止執行**

This is a genuinely different formal/legal noun and verb meaning.

Meaning: An official suspension or postponement of a legal process, judgment, or order.

Practice 24

> “The court granted a **stay** of the order.”

「法院批准**暫緩執行該命令**。」

Practice 25

> “The judge agreed to **stay** the proceedings temporarily.”

「法官同意暫時**中止／暫緩法律程序**。」

****stay — legal = 由法院正式暫停某項法律程序、命令或裁決的執行****

13. ****stay of execution (法律) — 暫緩執行判決／死刑****

A well-established legal expression.

Practice 26

> “The court issued a ****stay of execution****.”

「法院頒令****暫緩執行判決／刑罰****。」

Practice 27

> “His lawyers requested a ****stay of execution****.”

「他的律師要求法院****暫緩執行刑罰****。」

****stay of execution = 法律上暫時停止執行法院已作出的判決或刑罰****

The exact legal application depends on jurisdiction.

14. ****staying = continuing to remain somewhere/in a state (停留／保持的過程) — 逗留；住宿；保持****

Usually ****staying**** is simply the ****ing form**** rather than a separate lexical meaning.

Practice 28

> “We’re ****staying**** in a hotel near the airport.”

「我們正在機場附近的酒店****住宿****。」

Practice 29

> “****Staying**** calm helped her deal with the problem.”

「****保持冷靜****幫助她處理了這個問題。」

****staying = stay 的持續形式, 可表示正在停留、住宿或保持某種狀態****

15. ****stay-at-home = person/lifestyle (主要留在家中的人／生活方式) — 常留在家中的; 居家的****

A useful family extension.

Practice 30

> “He describes himself as a ****stay-at-home**** type.”

「他形容自己是個****比較喜歡待在家、不太常外出的人****。」

Practice 31

> “She became a ****stay-at-home parent**** after the baby was born.”

「孩子出生後, 她成為一名****主要留在家中照顧孩子的家長****。」

****stay-at-home = 大部分時間留在家中, 或在家照顧家庭為主要角色的****

16. ****staying power = ability to continue/succeed for a long time — 持久力; 持續成功的能力****

Another very useful family extension.

****Meaning:**** The ability to continue for a long time without failing, losing popularity, or giving up.

Practice 32

> “The brand has shown remarkable ****staying power****.”

「這個品牌展現了很強的****持久生命力, 長期仍能維持市場地位****。」

Practice 33

> “The singer proved that she had real ****staying power****.”

「這位歌手證明自己具有真正的****長期發展和維持成功的能力****。」

****staying power = 能長時間維持力量、人氣、成功或努力的能力****

17. **stay put = remain exactly where you are — 留在原地; 不要移動**

This is a very common fixed expression.

Practice 34

> “**Stay put** until I come back.”

「在我回來之前**留在原地, 不要走開**。」

Practice 35

> “The doctor told him to **stay put** for a few minutes.”

「醫生叫他**暫時留在原位, 不要移動**。」

****stay put = 繼續留在目前的位置, 不要離開或移動****

This is a fixed expression rather than a new core lexical meaning.

Important semantic point: the core idea of **stay**

Most everyday meanings of **stay** come from one broad concept:

> **continue to be somewhere or in some condition instead of leaving or changing**

That explains:

* **stay here** → 留在這裡

* **stay calm** → 保持冷靜

* **stay open** → 繼續營業

* **stay in the profession** → 繼續從事這個行業

* **a memory stays with you** → 記憶繼續留在心中

We should therefore ****not artificially treat every different object or context as a separate unrelated meaning****.

Important distinction: ****stay vs remain****

They overlap strongly.

stay

Very common in everyday English.

> “Stay here.”

「留在這裡。」

remain

More formal, and often means continue in the same state/place.

> “The door remained closed.”

「門一直保持關閉。」

Compare:

> “Please stay calm.”

> Everyday and natural.

> “Please remain calm.”

> More formal, common in announcements/instructions.

Important distinction: **stay vs live**

live

usually describes your normal/permanent home.

> “I **live** in Seattle.”

「我住在西雅圖。」

stay

usually suggests temporary accommodation.

> “I’m **staying** in Seattle for two weeks.”

「我會在西雅圖**暫住兩星期**。」

So:

****live = 長期／日常居住****

****stay = 暫時住宿／逗留****

Important distinction: **stay vs visit**

**visit**

emphasizes going somewhere to see someone/place.

> “We visited Paris.”

「我們遊覽／到訪巴黎。」

**stay**

emphasizes remaining there for a period.

> “We stayed in Paris for a week.”

「我們在巴黎逗留了一星期。」

A visit can be very brief and may not involve accommodation.

Important distinction: **stay vs keep**

Both can express continuation, but the grammar differs.

**stay + adjective**

> “Stay quiet.”

「保持安靜。」

**keep + noun/adjective/-ing**

> “Keep the door closed.”

「保持門關著。」

> “Keep working.”

「繼續工作。」

We normally say:

> **stay calm** 

rather than:

> *stay working*  in most ordinary contexts.

Important distinction: **stay with me — memory vs accommodation**

This is especially important because the exact same words can have two very different interpretations.

Mental/memory meaning

> “That image **stayed with me**.”

= **那個意象一直留在我的記憶中。**

Accommodation meaning

> “My friend **stayed with me**.”

= **我的朋友暫住在我家。**

The subject tells you which meaning is intended:

* **memory / image / comment / experience stays with someone** → 久久不能忘記

* **person stays with someone** → 暫住在對方家中

Family-extension note

Following our Golden Manual, useful extensions include:

* **stay-at-home** = 居家的／主要留在家中的
 * **staying power** = 持久力／長期維持成功的能力
 * **hospital stay** = 住院期
 * **overnight stay** = 過夜住宿
 * **stay put** = 留在原地
 * **stay of execution** = 暫緩執行判決

There are also technical meanings of **stay** involving structural support ropes/wires, but those are sufficiently specialist that I would **not include them in our normal learner list unless they arise in a passage**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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stay + place	繼續留在某個地方，而不是離開或前往其他地方
stay + adjective/state	持續處於某種狀態，沒有改變
stay — level/situation	某個數值、情況或特質持續維持原來水平
image/memory stays with someone	某個畫面、說話或經歷在事情過後仍長時間留在記憶中
person stays with someone	暫時住在某人的住所
stay at/in accommodation/place	在某地方短期住宿或逗留，而非永久居住
stay — remain for a period	在某地方繼續逗留一段時間，而不是立即離開
stay in activity/profession	繼續參與或處於某項活動、職業或情況中
stay on route/in position	繼續保持在指定路線、位置或方向上
a stay	在某個地方暫時居住或逗留的一段時間
hospital stay	留在醫院接受治療或觀察的一段時間
stay — legal	法院正式暫停法律程序、命令或裁決的執行
stay of execution	暫時停止執行法院已作出的判決或刑罰
stay-at-home	大部分時間留在家中或主要在家照顧家庭的
staying power	能長時間維持力量、人氣、努力或成功的能力
stay put	繼續留在目前位置，不要離開或移動

For your original sentence

> “That image really **stayed with me**.”

The exact meaning is:

****stay with someone = 某個意象、說話、經歷或感受在事情過去後仍長時間留在某人的腦海和記憶中****

So:

> **That image really stayed with me.**

= **那個意象真的給我留下非常深刻的印象，一直留在我的腦海中，令我久久不能忘記。**